

## Code of Conduct

Document owner: Legal and Compliance Version 4.0, effective 2026-01-01 Applies to: all TechLance Solutions employees, contractors, and contingent workers

Every employee completes Code of Conduct training within the first 10 business days of employment and annually thereafter.

### Expected behavior

**Treat people with respect.** Disagreement about work is expected and healthy. Personal attacks, intimidation, and demeaning conduct are not.

**Be truthful in company records.** This includes timesheets, expense reports, client deliverables, performance documentation, and status reporting. Misrepresenting the state of work is a conduct matter, not merely a performance matter.

**Protect information.** Client data, personnel data, and company confidential information are handled per the Information Security and Acceptable Use Policy.

**Follow the law.** This includes anti-bribery, anti-corruption, competition, sanctions, and employment law in every jurisdiction where TechLance operates.

### Prohibited conduct

- Harassment or discrimination based on race, color, religion, sex, sexual orientation, gender identity, national origin, age, disability, veteran status, or any other protected characteristic.
- Retaliation against anyone who raises a concern in good faith or participates in an investigation.
- Working while impaired in a way that affects safety or performance.
- Threats or violence of any kind.
- Unauthorized access to systems, data, or physical premises.

### Conflicts of interest

Disclose any situation where personal interest could reasonably appear to influence a business decision. Common examples:

- A financial interest in a client, supplier, or competitor beyond ordinary publicly traded holdings.
- Outside employment or consulting that overlaps with TechLance business.
- Hiring, managing, or making compensation decisions about a relative or someone with whom the employee has a close personal relationship.
- Serving on the board of an organization that does business with TechLance.

Disclosure goes to Legal and Compliance through the conflicts register. **Disclosure is required even when the employee believes no actual conflict**

**exists.** Legal and Compliance determines whether a conflict requires management, recusal, or no action; that determination is not made by the employee or their manager.

## Gifts and hospitality

| Situation                                                   | Rule                                                                        |
|-------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Gift or hospitality under \$100 from a non-government party | Permitted, no approval needed                                               |
| \$100 to \$250                                              | Permitted with manager approval, recorded in the register                   |
| Over \$250                                                  | Requires Legal and Compliance approval before acceptance                    |
| Anything to or from a government official                   | Prohibited without prior Legal and Compliance approval, regardless of value |
| Cash or cash equivalents                                    | Prohibited at any value                                                     |

Gifts must never be offered or accepted to influence a business decision, and the value thresholds above do not make an improper gift acceptable.

## Use of AI tools

Employees may use approved AI tools for work. Three rules apply:

1. **Do not input client confidential data, personnel data, or company confidential information into any tool that has not been approved for that data class.** The approved tool list is maintained in the Information Security and Acceptable Use Policy.
2. **Verify output before relying on it.** AI-generated content used in a client deliverable, a decision, or a company record is the employee's responsibility, not the tool's.
3. **Disclose AI-generated content** where a reader would reasonably assume human authorship, including client deliverables and performance documentation.

AI tools must not be used to make employment decisions about individuals, including hiring, performance rating, or termination, without human review and a documented human decision.

## Raising concerns

Report suspected violations to any of: your manager, People Operations, Legal and Compliance, or the confidential ethics line.

Reports may be made anonymously. TechLance does not tolerate retaliation against anyone raising a concern in good faith. Retaliation is itself a violation of this Code and is treated as seriously as the underlying concern.

**Investigations are conducted by Legal and Compliance and People Operations. Managers who receive a report must escalate it and must not investigate it themselves.**

## **Consequences**

Violations may result in coaching, a written warning, removal from a role, or termination, depending on severity. Some violations may also carry legal consequences.